

Chicago Tribune



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Groups trying to slash gas rate hike

Regulator urged to cut Peoples’ planned increase by \$137M

By Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Consumer groups filed testimony with the Illinois Commerce Commission this week urging regulators to slash two-thirds from a proposed \$202 million rate increase by Peoples Gas, pointing to continued “wasteful spending” in the accelerated pipeline replacement program.

Separate filings by Illinois PIRG and Citizens Utility Board are seeking to cut a combined \$137 million from the Peoples rate request. In addition to the pipeline program, the groups want to scale back the utility’s proposed profit margin and executive compensation plans.

Meanwhile, the Illinois attorney general’s office took it a step further, recommending a rate cut for Peoples Gas next year.

Peoples Gas filed for the \$202 million rate increase in January, primarily to recover projected costs for its ongoing multibillion-dollar pipeline replacement program. Last year, the ICC ordered the utility to complete replacement of the remaining 1,020 miles of aging iron pipes under Chicago by 2035.

If approved, the rate increase request would raise average residential customer delivery charges by \$10 to \$11 per month beginning in 2027. The ICC is expected to complete its review and issue a ruling by November.

In its filing, PIRG included expert testimony projecting

See **RATES** on Page A6



Mayor Brandon Johnson laughs with Illinois House Speaker Emanuel “Chris” Welch after taking a photo together before meeting in Welch’s office at the Illinois State Capitol building on Wednesday. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Johnson’s field day

In Springfield, mayor pushes against Bears’ move to suburbs, for Chicago funding boost

By Jeremy Gorner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SPRINGFIELD — Chicago Mayor Brandon Johnson arrived at the state Capitol on Wednesday with an ambitious agenda and three weeks before the General Assembly’s scheduled adjournment as he pressed lawmakers on a sweeping set of priorities — from pushing the state to increase a critical source

of municipal revenue to making a last-ditch effort to keep the Chicago Bears from leaving the city.

Previous efforts by Johnson to get the support he seeks from Springfield have gotten middling results at best. But on his third visit as mayor to the state capital, Johnson met with an array of legislative leaders, including Democratic House Speaker Emanuel “Chris” Welch of Hill-

side and members of the Black and Asian American caucuses, as he also attended a Latino Unity Day event on the southern end of town.

Flanked at meetings by his chief of staff, former state Sen. Cristina Pacione-Zayas, and other top aides, Johnson urged lawmakers to increase Chicago’s share of state revenue, advance several new city taxing authorities, and weigh in on legislation that could determine whether the Bears stay in Illinois at all.

See **JOHNSON** on Page A7

“We’re building a football stadium in the South Loop. It’s international football (with the) Chicago Fire. So we clearly can build in Chicago. There’s a benefit for all of us with the Bears remaining in Chicago.”

MAYOR BRANDON JOHNSON

After botched raid at her Chicago home, Anjanette Young draws one step closer to serving on police oversight board



‘CHANGING MY EXPERIENCE’

By Jake Sheridan | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Anjanette Young, a leading Chicago police reform activist since cops stormed her home in a botched raid, could soon have a key role overseeing the Chicago Police Department. Aldermen on Wednesday advanced Mayor Brandon Johnson’s appointment of Young to the Community Commission for Public Safety and Accountability.

Young, who has led a push to ban “no-knock” warrants like the one that saw her handcuffed naked in her home by officers who had the wrong address, argued the police failure that harmed her makes her well-suited for the civilian oversight body.

See **YOUNG** on Page A4

Anjanette Young, center, smiles after her nomination to join the Community Commission for Public Safety and Accountability passed out of a Chicago City Council committee on Wednesday. Young’s home was raided in 2019 in a Chicago Police Department error that sparked reform. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

ANALYSIS

Trump flexes power in Indiana primaries

Five GOP state senators who defied president on redistricting effort lose seats to challengers

By Thomas Beaumont and Bill Barrow
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Five months ago, President Donald Trump was stinging from one of the first political defeats of his second term as Republican state senators defied him on redistricting in Indiana.

Now he has proved he can still punish wayward party members after he endorsed a slate of challengers who defeated almost every one of the lawmakers he wanted to dislodge.

But that success may not help Republicans’ odds in November’s midterm elections, when Trump’s sagging poll numbers, lingering inflation and frustration over the war with Iran have boosted Democrats’ chance of retaking

control of Congress. Some Republicans are worried that intraparty fights are costing time and money that should be focused on defending their majorities in Washington.

“Every dollar going toward keeping seats we already have, and not winning ones we don’t, really matters,” said Rick Tyler, a Republican strategist who has been critical of the president.

However, Trump doesn’t seem to have any second thoughts about purging his party of dissenters. Indiana’s primary will likely bolster his confidence in other primaries this month, as he tries to oust U.S. Sen. Bill Cassidy of Louisiana and U.S. Rep. Thomas Massie of Kentucky.

See **TRUMP** on Page A2

CHICAGOLAND

Davis aide faces fraud charges

An aide to longtime U.S. Rep. Danny Davis was indicted Wednesday on federal COVID-19 fraud charges alleging he lied about being unemployed to illegally collect nearly \$32,000 in pandemic-related subsidies.

SPORTS

Cubs’ Boyd to have surgery

The Cubs ran into another obstacle in their injury-plagued season Wednesday, placing starting pitcher Matthew Boyd on the 15-day injured list with a torn meniscus in his knee.

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WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY H: 61 L: 44
FRI. H: 63 L: 46
SAT. H: 75 L: 45
Complete details on Page A14

INDEX

Almanac A11
Arts & Living B7
Comics B12-B13

Crossword B13
Editorials A8
Horoscope B12

Nation & World B4
Obituaries A11
Television B11

178th Year No. 127
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